ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Campus Safety and Scam Awareness: Protect Your Money and Yourself

Practical habits against fraud, theft and unsafe situations on and around campus

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Students lose money to fake agents, fake accommodation, fake scholarship portals and social-engineering calls. This pack covers how common scams work, how to verify before paying, safe meet-up habits and what to do after an incident.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Recognise common student-targeted scams and the pressure tactics they use.
- Verify a person, offer or portal before sending money.
- Apply personal-safety habits for late travel and meet-ups.
- Report incidents correctly and preserve evidence.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

How scams work

Fraud relies on urgency, authority and isolation. Break any one and the scam usually fails.

- Fake accommodation agents demand a deposit before inspection.
- Fake scholarship or job portals charge an application or processing fee.
- Impersonation calls claim to be from the bursary, your bank or a lecturer.
- Fake buyers overpay and ask for a refund of the difference.
- Investment schemes promise unrealistic daily returns and pay early members with later members' money.
- Pressure to act immediately and secretly is the strongest warning sign.

> **The pause rule**
> No legitimate transaction collapses because you took ten minutes to verify. If someone insists you cannot check, do not pay.

Verify before you pay

Verification is a process, not a feeling about the person.

1. Confirm identity through an independent channel you found yourself.
2. Verify ownership or authority with the institution, landlord or employer.
3. Never pay into a personal account for an institutional fee.
4. Ask for a written receipt and keep records of the conversation.
5. Check the official website or portal rather than a link sent to you.
6. For goods, inspect before paying; for services, agree milestones.

Personal safety and reporting

Most risk is managed by routine rather than by fear.

- Share your movement with a trusted friend when travelling late.
- Use well-lit, populated routes and registered transport.
- Meet buyers or sellers in public, busy locations during daylight.
- Keep bank alerts on and never share your PIN or OTP with anyone.
- Avoid displaying expensive items unnecessarily.
- After an incident, report to campus security and the police, and preserve messages and receipts.

Risk is mostly about routine

Most campus incidents happen in predictable circumstances: late at night, alone, on routes with poor lighting, or during periods of unusual movement such as examination week and end of semester. Knowing the pattern lets you change it rather than living in fear.

Practical measures are unglamorous: travel in groups at night, tell someone your route and expected arrival time, keep your phone charged, know where security posts are, and avoid unlit shortcuts even when they are shorter.

Your valuables are most at risk during transitions - moving into a hostel, examination periods, crowded functions, and the days before holidays. Most theft on campus is opportunistic and happens when attention is elsewhere.

Scams that target students

Common patterns: a "bursary" or "scholarship" that requires an upfront payment; a "course registration" agent who collects money and disappears; fake accommodation agents; messages claiming a relative is in trouble; investment schemes promising fast returns; and requests to receive money on someone else's behalf.

The rule that defeats almost all of them: legitimate institutions do not require payment to release money, and no genuine offer needs you to act within minutes. Urgency is the mechanism. Slow down, verify through an official channel you found yourself, and ask someone you trust.

Never share your bank details, PIN, OTP or password with anyone, including someone claiming to be from your bank. A bank will never ask for your PIN. An OTP read aloud is a transfer authorised by you.

> **Verify through a channel you chose**
> Do not call the number in the message. Find the official number yourself and call that. The scammer controls the number in the message.

If something happens

Report immediately, even if you feel foolish. Delays help the offender and reduce the chance of recovery. Report to campus security, the police, and your bank in the case of financial fraud - in that order of speed.

Preserve evidence: screenshots, transaction references, message threads, names and times. A report without evidence is much harder to act on.

Look after yourself afterwards. Being robbed or defrauded is not a personal failure, and the shame that keeps people silent is what protects the offender.

WORKED EXAMPLES

Do it once, slowly

These are not model answers to copy. They show the reasoning a strong student would use, step by step, so you can repeat the process on a question you have not seen.

1. Assessing a scholarship message

A message says you have won a grant and must pay 5,000 naira to process it today.

1. Identify the emotion being used: urgency and flattery.
2. Check the rule: legitimate grants do not require payment to release funds.
3. Verify independently using the institution's official website or office.
4. Ask what organisation the sender represents and whether the domain matches.
5. Do not pay, and do not send documents.
6. Report the message to the university and warn your classmates.

> **What to carry forward**
> Money out to get money in is the oldest scam structure there is.

2. Safe late-night travel

You must leave the library at 9 p.m.

1. Plan the route in advance along lit, populated paths.
2. Travel with someone or wait for a group.
3. Tell a friend your route and expected arrival time.
4. Keep your phone charged and accessible, not buried in a bag.
5. Note the nearest security post on the way.
6. Message on arrival so someone knows you are safe.

> **What to carry forward**
> Plan the route, share the plan, arrive and confirm.

EXAM TECHNIQUE

Questions with model answers

Written in the shape your course is usually examined, with the marking logic spelled out. Attempt each one under time before you read the outline.

Q1. Identify three common scams targeting students and the principle that defeats each.

15 marks

1. Upfront payment for a grant or scholarship - legitimate funds do not require payment.
2. Fake agent for registration or accommodation - verify through official channels.
3. Urgent family emergency message - verify by calling the person directly on a known number.
4. State the general principle: urgency plus payment plus unverifiable identity.

Q2. What should a student do immediately after a theft or fraud?

10 marks

1. Report to campus security and police.
2. Contact the bank immediately for financial fraud.
3. Preserve evidence: screenshots, references, times.
4. Inform the department if documents were taken.

REFERENCE

Glossary

Use these definitions in your own sentences; a copied definition rarely earns full marks.

Phishing. A fraudulent message designed to obtain credentials or money.

OTP. A one-time password used to authorise a transaction.

Social engineering. Manipulating people into revealing information or acting against their interest.

Advance-fee fraud. A scam requiring payment before a promised benefit is released.

Opportunistic theft. Theft taking advantage of an unguarded moment rather than planning.

Security post. A manned campus point for reporting incidents and requesting escort.

Evidence trail. Records such as screenshots and references that support a report.

Shoulder surfing. Observing someone entering a PIN or password.

Identity theft. Using another person's details to obtain money or services.

Escort service. Campus arrangement to accompany students across unsafe areas.

Your four-week plan

Week 1 - Map

Routes.

- Identify lit routes and security posts.
- Note two places to avoid at night.
- Save security numbers.

Week 2 - Habits

Routine.

- Adopt the travel-with-someone rule.
- Set up phone tracking or check-in with a friend.
- Secure valuables in your room.

Week 3 - Scams

Recognition.

- List five scam patterns you have seen.
- Practise independent verification.
- Warn two classmates.

Week 4 - Response

Reporting.

- Write a report template.
- Know the bank fraud number.
- Rehearse what you would preserve as evidence.

Where to read more

Entry-level texts you can find in the university library or a departmental reading list. Confirm editions with your lecturer.

- Your university security office guidance.
- Your bank's fraud reporting instructions.
- A consumer protection guide on common fraud patterns.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Name three pressure tactics used by scammers.

Answer: Urgency, claimed authority and secrecy or isolation from people who could verify the offer.

2. Why is paying a deposit before inspecting accommodation risky?

Answer: The property may not exist or the person may not be authorised to collect rent, and recovery is difficult.

3. How should you verify a scholarship offer?

Answer: Check the official university or sponsor website and contact the institution through independently sourced contact details.

4. What should you do if you receive a suspicious call claiming to be your bank?

Answer: Hang up and call the bank's official number yourself. Never share PINs, OTPs or card details.

5. What evidence should you preserve after a scam?

Answer: Chats, call logs, account details, receipts and transaction references, along with a written timeline.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Save official university, bank and security numbers in your phone.
- [ ] Agree a late-travel check-in routine with a friend.
- [ ] Review your bank alert settings.
- [ ] Practise verifying one offer before paying.
- [ ] Learn where campus security is located.
- [ ] Write down the reporting steps for fraud.
- [ ] Talk through one scam example with a coursemate.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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